

Emergency Decisions Unit Pathway

Hypoglycaemia

Date DD/MM/YY

Has lived in UK > 1 year?

☐ Yes ☐ No

Patient details

Full name

DoB

Unit number

(use sticker if available)

Inclusion criteria

Diabetic patient who presents to ED with an episode of hypoglycaemia
Period of observation likely to be less than 12 hours

Exclusion criteria

Inter-current medical condition or illness that requires admission to AMU
EWS >2
Patient's low glucose not responding to treatment
Pregnancy
Patient on insulin pump

This pathway is for use for patients who are diabetic and present to the ED with hypoglycaemia, who need a period of observation.

Patients with hypoglycaemia should be treated as per the UHL guideline, available on insite. A copy of the algorithm from this document can be found on the back of the ED hypoglycaemia pathway.

Support in the management of these patients, to facilitate discharge, should be obtained from the Diabetes Specialist Nurses (DSN) on bleep 4226 (Mon- Fri, 9am-5pm). Form should be faxed as per checklist.

Patients on insulin should have dose reduced by 20% or 4 units. Do not omit dose

Review oral medication if patient is on a sulphonylurea (eg gliclazide) and reduce dose by 50%

EDU Plan

Management checklist

All patients should have:

Patent IV cannula	☐
Drug chart written, including own regular medication	☐
Hypoglycaemia Referral form / fax sheet completed. To be faxed by EDU staff to 0116 2734845	☐
Plan documented on this sheet including expected period needed until discharge if well and observations / BM frequency	☐
Please tick here if patient suitable for nurse discharge from EDU, when seen by the DSN and note relevant aspects for this on the EDU Plan section of this form	☐

On discharge

All patients should have:

Advice re recognition and treatment of hypoglycaemia	☐
Patient information leaflet on hypoglycaemia treatment and contact information sheet	☐

Planned & agreed by

Print names

Signatures

Referring doctor

Doctor in Charge

Nurse in charge

NB: Pathway Must be signed by both Doctor and Nurse in Charge